

Wednesday, 8 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Clear

31° 21°

BIRMINGHAM

Partly cloudy

30° 18°

MANCHESTER

Partly cloudy

27° 17°

GLASGOW

Overcast

22° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Nigel Farage is attempting to regain control of the political narrative, following recent questions about his party's finances.

His stated aim for the upcoming by-election campaign is to position it as 'the people versus the establishment'. This follows his resignation as an MP to trigger the by-election, which he will stand in.

POLITICS · UK

2

An inquiry is being urged to investigate alleged sex abuse and 'baby trading' within mother and baby homes across the UK.

Thousands of women and girls, often in secretive institutions run by religious orders, passed through these homes from the 1920s to the 1990s. This comes as more details emerge about the experiences of those who were housed there.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK

3

There's good news for those suffering from endometriosis, as two new tests are set to speed up diagnosis at GP surgeries.

Experts hope these new tests will be a real game-changer, potentially cutting the incredibly long diagnosis waits patients currently face, which can be nine years or even longer. This could significantly improve quality of life for many.

HEALTH · UK

4

Some of the UK's biggest banks are reportedly failing their most vulnerable customers, by pushing them away from basic accounts.

The financial regulator has accused banks of not adequately informing customers about their options. This raises concerns about access to essential banking services for those who need them most.

CONSUMER · UK

5

Payouts for injuries involving e-bikes have now topped a staggering £110 million, leading to a rise in insurance premiums.

It's a relatively new issue, with the first claim over a micromobility vehicle injury made just seven years ago. The rapid increase in claims highlights growing concerns around safety and regulation.

SAFETY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Harry Styles has officially earned a Guinness World Record for the longest run of shows at Wembley Stadium by a single artist.**

The 'Watermelon Sugar' singer is the first to perform twelve shows on one tour at the iconic London venue. It's a testament to his incredible popularity and the enduring appeal of his live performances.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable concert you've ever been to at Wembley?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 2 Brighton-born author Patrice Lawrence has been named the new Children's Laureate, a prestigious role in children's literature.**

She will serve as the main representative for children's literature until 2028, inspiring young readers and promoting the importance of books. It's a fantastic honour for a celebrated writer.

ON AIR – What was your favourite book when you were a child?

BOOKS · THIS WEEK
- 3 Sky is set to acquire ITV's TV and streaming channels in a massive £1.6 billion deal, with implications for your favourite shows.**

The good news is that popular ITV hits like 'I'm a Celebrity' are expected to remain free to watch. It's a huge shake-up in the UK broadcasting landscape.

ON AIR – What are your must-watch shows on ITV that you hope won't change?

TV · THIS WEEK
- 4 UK rapper Megan Da Savage has thanked Linkin Park for 'changing her life' after receiving a freestyle shout-out from the band.**

Mike Shinoda from Linkin Park discovered her rap on an independent music platform, leading to this incredible recognition. It's a brilliant story of new talent being discovered.

ON AIR – Which artist would you love to get a shout-out from?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 5 Screenwriter Russell T Davies has hinted at a new TV project, but admits he 'doesn't know if it works' yet.**

The Swansea-born writer, known for 'Doctor Who' and 'It's A Sin', is always pushing boundaries with his storytelling. We'll be eagerly awaiting details of his next venture.

ON AIR – What kind of TV show would you love to see Russell T Davies create next?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **British wildcard Arthur Fery has made history at Wimbledon, reaching the quarter-finals after a stunning five-set victory.**

Fery came from two sets to one down to beat Grigor Dimitrov in a thrilling fifth-set tiebreak. He's the first British wildcard ever to reach a Grand Slam quarter-final, sparking huge excitement.

ON AIR – How far do you think Arthur Fery can go in this tournament?

TENNIS · UK

2 **Coco Gauff has fought back to reach her first-ever Wimbledon semi-final, earning her 'comeback queen' title.**

She defeated compatriot Jessica Pegula in three sets, showcasing incredible resilience on court. Gauff is now a serious contender for the title.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win the women's singles at Wimbledon this year?

TENNIS · UK

3 **The Scottish Open is underway, with Jon Rahm returning to PGA Tour action on a rejigged Renaissance Club layout.**

Golf fans will be keen to see how Rahm performs and how the course changes impact the tournament. It's a key event in the golf calendar this week.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of course changes in golf, or do you prefer tradition?

GOLF · UK

4 **Britain's Alfie Hewett is through to his tenth Wimbledon wheelchair singles quarter-final, continuing his impressive run.**

Hewett is a formidable force in wheelchair tennis and will be looking to add another title to his collection. His compatriot Gordon Reid, however, was unfortunately knocked out in the first round.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite British athlete to watch at Wimbledon?

TENNIS · UK

5 **Former France star Virimi Vakatawa is set for a surprise Test comeback, potentially turning out for Fiji against England this Saturday.**

Vakatawa, known for his power and pace in France's midfield, could be a significant boost for Fiji. It adds an intriguing element to the upcoming rugby match.

ON AIR – What do you think about players making comebacks for different national teams?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'mindful walking' as a way to connect with their surroundings.**
Instead of rushing, individuals are taking slower strolls, paying close attention to sights, sounds, and smells, reporting reduced stress and increased appreciation for everyday beauty.
- 2 Researchers are noting the growing popularity of 'community swap shops' for household items.**
These local initiatives allow neighbours to exchange pre-loved goods, from books to kitchenware, fostering a sense of community and promoting sustainability.
- 3 The enduring appeal of 'traditional board games' is bringing families and friends together for screen-free entertainment.**
From classic chess to intricate strategy games, people are rediscovering the joy of face-to-face competition and collaborative play.
- 4 An emerging trend sees people 'hand-making greeting cards' to add a personal touch to their messages.**
Instead of store-bought options, many are finding creative satisfaction in crafting unique cards for birthdays, anniversaries, and other special occasions.
- 5 A recent study suggests that listening to the gentle sound of 'rain on a windowpane' can be surprisingly calming for some.**
The rhythmic patter creates a soothing background noise, helping to relax the mind and even aid in falling asleep.
- 6 The trend of 'urban gardening on balconies' is gaining popularity, with city dwellers growing herbs and vegetables in small spaces.**
Even without a large garden, people are enjoying the satisfaction of cultivating their own produce, adding a touch of green to their urban environments.
- 7 Experts are noting a rise in popularity for 'vintage vinyl records' as a warm alternative to digital music.**
Many are seeking out classic albums on vinyl, appreciating the rich sound quality and the nostalgic experience of physically engaging with music.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we open a new packet of biscuits, even if we know we shouldn't?

ANSWER: LOOKING FOR THE UNBROKEN ONES FIRST!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'ritual' they absolutely have to do before leaving the house on a big day. What is it?

ANSWER: CHECKING THE FRONT DOOR AT LEAST TWICE, EVEN IF THEY'VE ALREADY LOCKED IT.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old childhood book' that you thought was long gone, and it brings back a flood of memories?

What was that special book for you, and what memories does it bring back?

- We all have those 'little quirks' when it comes to how we organise our kitchen cupboards – perhaps a specific shelf for mugs or a very particular way the tins face?

What's your slightly unusual but essential kitchen cupboard organisation rule?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights can make audible crackling sounds that can sometimes be heard from the ground.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the frisbee was cremated and his ashes were moulded into frisbees.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- Cows don't have upper front teeth; instead, they have a tough dental pad.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana in 1887.
- Mount Everest grows by about 4 millimetres every year due to geological uplift.
- The only letter that doesn't appear in any U.S. state name is 'Q'.

On this day

Day 189 of the year, 176 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Abda and Sabas; Christian Feast Day: Auspicius of Trier; Christian Feast Day: Grimbald; Christian Feast Day: Landrada. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — Steve Lawrence, American actor and singer (died 2024)
- 1947 — Kim Darby, American actress
- 1923 — Val Bettin, American actor (died 2021)
- 1944 — Jaimoe, American drummer
- 1940 — Joe B. Mauldin, American bass player and songwriter (died 2015)
- 1980 — Robbie Keane, Irish footballer
- 1998 — Jaden Smith, American actor and rapper
- 1961 — Andrew Fletcher, English keyboard player (died 2022)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1912 — Henrique Mitchell de Paiva Couceiro leads an unsuccessful royalist attack against the First Portuguese Republic in Chaves.
- 1982 — A failed assassination attempt against Iraqi president Saddam Hussein results in the Dujail Massacre over the next several months.
- 1968 — The Chrysler wildcat strike begins in Detroit, Michigan.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1988 — The Island Express train travelling from Bangalore to Kanyakumari derails on the Peruman bridge and falls into Ashtamudi Lake, Kerala in India killing 105 passengers and injuring over 200 more.
- 1970 — Richard Nixon delivers a special congressional message enunciating Native American self-determination as official US Indian policy, leading to the Indian Self-Determination and Education Assistance Act of 1975.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1912 — Henrique Mitchell de Paiva Couceiro leads an unsuccessful royalist attack against the First Portuguese Republic in Chaves.
- 1966 — King Mwambutsa IV Bangiriceng of Burundi is deposed by his son Prince Charles Ndizi.

- 1994 — Space Shuttle Columbia is launched on an international science mission.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 190 of the year, 175 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Cambodia); Christian Feast Day: Amandina of Schakkebroek (one of Martyrs of Southern Hunan); Christian Feast Day: Blessed Marija Petković; Christian Feast Day: Everilda. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Frank Bello, American bass player
- 1951 — Chris Cooper, American actor
- 1972 — Ara Babajian, American drummer and songwriter
- 1957 — Paul Merton, English comedian, actor, and screenwriter
- 1987 — Rebecca Sugar, American animator, composer, and screenwriter
- 1956 — Tom Hanks, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1974 — Gary Kelly, Irish footballer
- 1986 — Kiely Williams, American singer-songwriter and dancer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1979 — A car bomb destroys a Renault motor car owned by "Nazi hunters" Serge and Beate Klarsfeld outside their home in France in an unsuccessful assassination attempt.
- 1955 — The Russell–Einstein Manifesto calls for a reduction of the risk of nuclear warfare.
- 1962 — Starfish Prime tests the effects of a nuclear explosion at orbital altitudes.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

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Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)